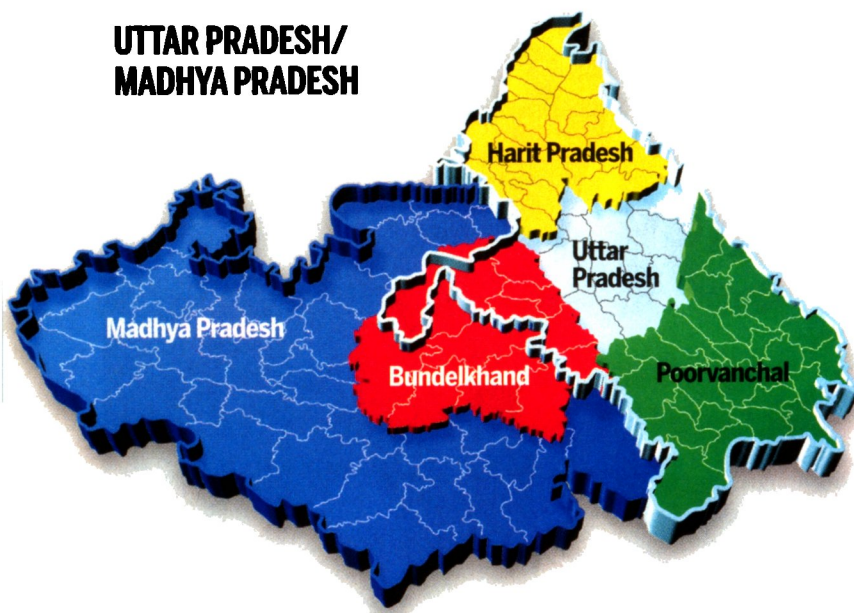


UTTAR PRADESH/ MADHYA PRADESH



Bundelkhand

Districts: Seven each from UP and MP

Population: 5 crore
Area: 60,000 sq km

MPs: 10 (including four from UP)
Economy: Includes MPs Panna diamond mines as well more than a dozen tourist spots. Is a perpetual victim of famine.

Harit Pradesh

Districts: 22

Population: 5 crore
Area: 50,000 sq km
MPs: 22

Economy: A part of the green revolution, its prosperity is comparable to that of Punjab and Haryana. Has a distinct cultural identity.

Poorvanchal

Districts: 27

Population: 6.66 crore
Area: 86,000 sq km
MPs: 23

Economy: Agriculture in the area offers a low productivity. It is ridden with acute poverty and zero industrialisation.

Uttar Pradesh

Districts: 15

Population: 3 crore
Area: 70,928 sq km
MPs: 31

Economy: The Kanpur industrial belt and mango cultivation are the mainstays of the region's economy.

GRAPHIC BY PRASHANT CHAUDHARY/www.indiatodayimages.com

Reddy for 26 projects and which proposed to irrigate 59 lakh hectares in the state show as much as 43 lakh hectares to be covered in coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema and only 16 lakh hectares in Telangana. Obviously, the assertion of Telangana identity is because of the region's high cost growth and the growing perception that development and a say in political decision-making are not possible within the integrated state.

This is why the aftershocks of Telangana are being felt across India among nascent, dormant and active campaigns for smaller states. These are more than competing demands for autonomy based on ethnic emotions. They are sustained by a history of economic and political discrimination. Successive governments in Maharashtra and Andhra

Pradesh have resorted to a range of appeasement ploys like creating regional development entities when the agitation for a separate Vidarbha and Telangana began. In West Bengal, the answer to the Gorkhas' aspiration was a powerless mechanism like the Hill Council. Resources have been cornered at the cost of poor and backward areas that continue to remain as pockets of neglect, which in turn, depending on the calibre of local leadership, has spawned separate statehood campaigns.

Take Uttar Pradesh, where the demand is for the creation of Bundelkhand, Harit Pradesh and Poorvanchal. The unwieldy state, the sixth largest administrative unit in the world, has 71 districts and if three more states are created, it will be reduced to just 15 which means Uttar

Pradesh will be mainly the Awadh region with 31 MPs as against the current 80. Mayawati has been propagating division since the day she took charge as chief minister for the fourth time in May 2007. Not surprisingly, Samajwadi Party chief Mulayam Singh Yadav is opposed to any such plan. And Telangana has inspired actor-director-producer Raja Bundela to gear up for a "peaceful movement" for the creation of Bundelkhand comprising 14 natural resources rich but hunger-ridden districts of Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh. "The only solution to all problems—poverty, hunger, lack of development and non-existent infrastructure—in the region is the creation of a separate state. People are fed up of the hollow politics of development packages," says the head of



“I have urged the prime minister to give clearance for carving out independent states of Bundelkhand and Harit Pradesh out of a giant-sized and unmanageable Uttar Pradesh.”

MAYAWATI, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister